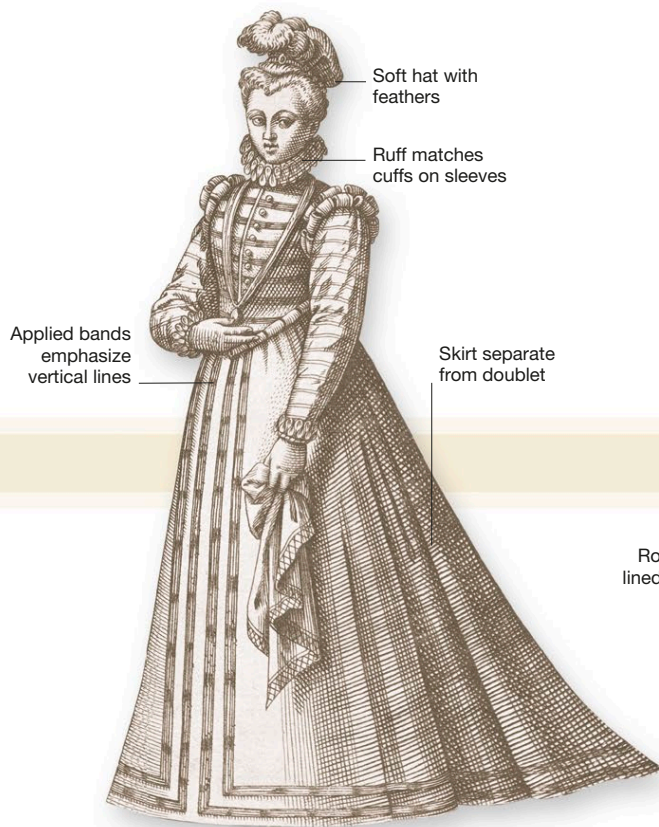
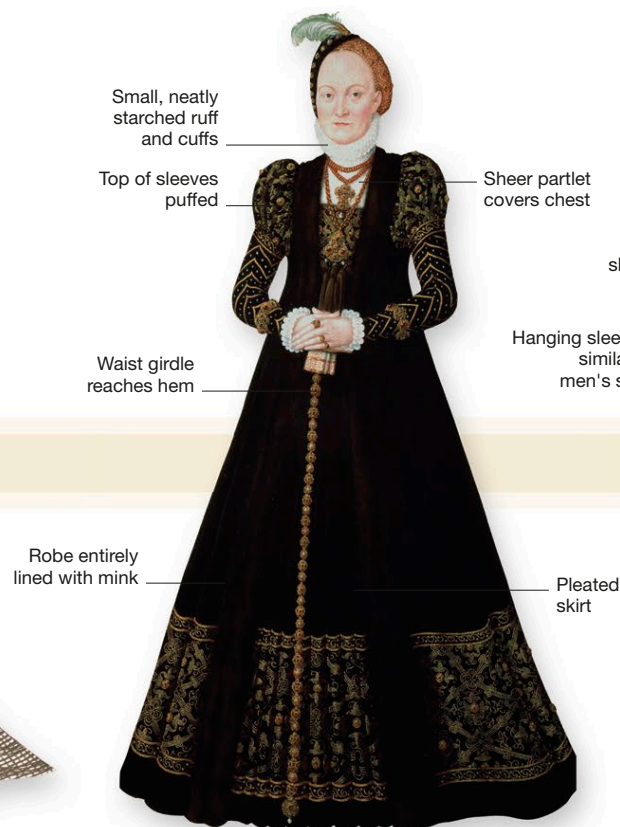
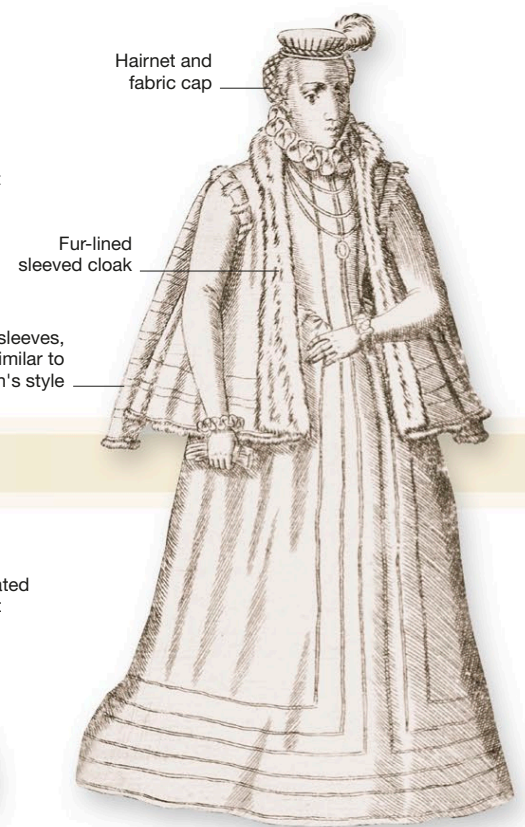




Masculine style This Flemish ensemble shows how the cut and tailoring of female dress borrowed from male clothing. The doublet has horizontal braid, front buttoning, and shoulder tabs just like a man's.



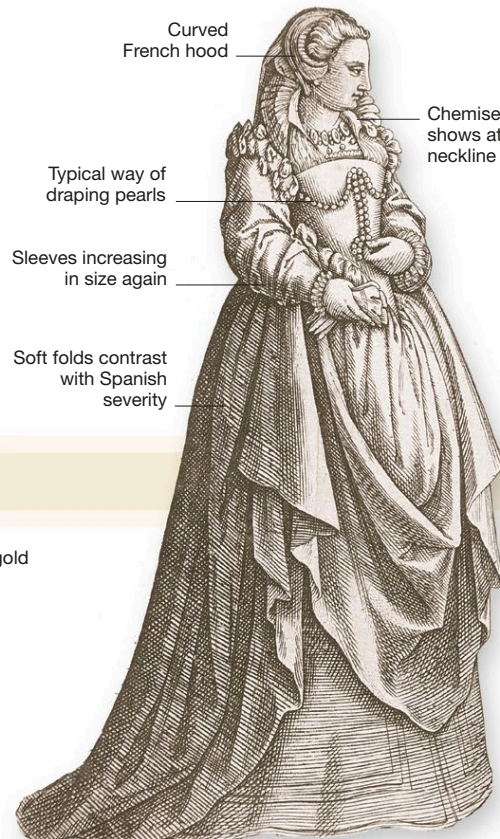
Saxon Anne, Electress of Saxony, in this painting from c.1565, wears a short-sleeved fitted robe over a low-necked gown. Her heavy gold jewellery, pleated skirt, and hairnet with cap are typically Saxon.



German woman Apart from her headwear, this noblewoman's dress keeps up with fashion in Europe. She wears petticoats without the rigidity of a farthingale. Women below her class or in rural areas dressed in more regional style.



Red and gold This sumptuous gown of c.1575 has an open front over a Spanish farthingale. The short oversleeves could be supported with boning, wire, or wood to create their shape. The sleeves and shoulders are encrusted with embroidery.



Married French noblewoman Mature women covered more of their heads, and widows were totally veiled. This gown's soft, full skirts are lifted above a narrower petticoat. The partlet's open collar is the predecessor of a standing ruff.

HAIRSTYLES

New clothes were costly and time consuming but hair could be changed every day. Another example of the inventive Renaissance love of finery, women's hair during the 16th century was parted in the centre, swept over the temples, curled, crimped, arranged over pads to keep the shape, frizzled, bewigged, piled into high peaks, or hidden. In Italy, bleaching hair blonde was particularly popular, as in the drawing of the Venetian woman below. Hair on the back of the head was curled up in plaits and became a support for hats and headdresses, fixed by pins. Women added jewels, ribbons, and feathers, like the ribbons perched on Anne of Denmark's fluffy mounds of hair.



Venetian woman



Anne of Denmark